FOGGS | Foundation for Global Governance and Sustainability

## Opening Panel

# Where We Are

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*Presentation at the*
*'Turning Words Into Action'*
*Global People's Forum for*
*the Future of the United Nations*
*8 December 2021 (on line)*

*Here we are! In…*

# «Polycrisia»

*An integral part and consequence of the 'Anthropocene'?*

***And as whenever we are in crisis / crises, it is all about Security…***

# Current state of the world I*

*Threats to* **human security**

- Covid-19 pandemic with successive waves & ‘vaccine apartheid’
- Climate crisis and post-carbon (just?) transition
- Pollution of the air, seas, land and water, incl. by plastics
- Water scarcity and food insecurity
- Desertification
- Biodiversity loss
- Refugee and migrant flows and associated tensions
- Social tensions, increasing intolerance and culture wars
- Push-back on established human rights, including gender
- Youth discontent and disconnect
- Democracy and rule of law as processes rather than lived reality
- Ethics and bio-ethics (or lack thereof)
- Cybercommons governance and digital transition
- Increasing inequalities and hyper-concetration of financial assets
- Unsustainable supply chains undermining local resilience
- Mounting debt crisis of the developing world and beyond

**List not exhaustive*

# Current state of the world II*

***Threats to***
**peace & security**

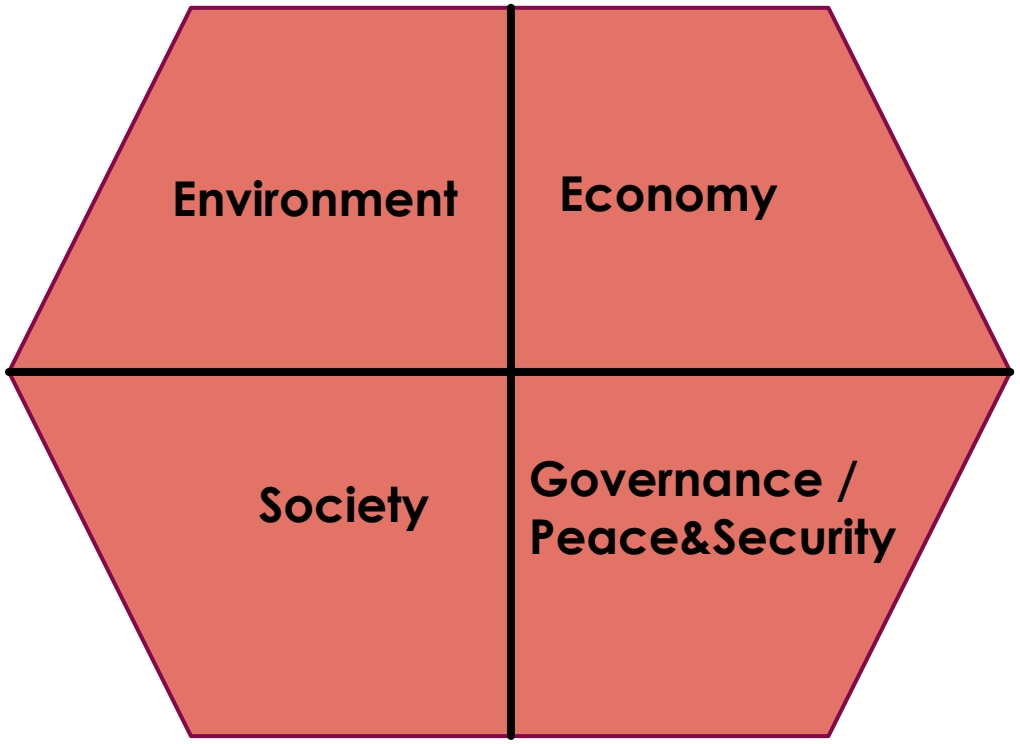
- Increasing geopolitical tensions
- A new ‘Cold War’?
- Nuclear arms proliferation
- Conventional arms proliferation
- Terrorism
- Cyberthreats and AI armies
- Mercenaries
- Militarization of outer space
- Security aspects of climate change

***List not exhaustive**

# Each threat / crisis is multi-dimensional

## [causes & possible solutions]

### CLIMATE CRISIS



# And all threats are interconnected, within and between the groups…

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*Threats to*
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*Threats to*
**peace & security**

*Lists not exhaustive*

# Means at our disposal

## FRAMEWORKS*

The United Nations Charter

The Universal Declaration of Human Rights

The 2030 Agenda and the SDGs

The Paris Agreement on climate change

## INSTITUTIONS*

The United Nations System

The International Financial Institutions (partly in the UN system)

EU / AU / ASEAN / CARICOM …

The G20

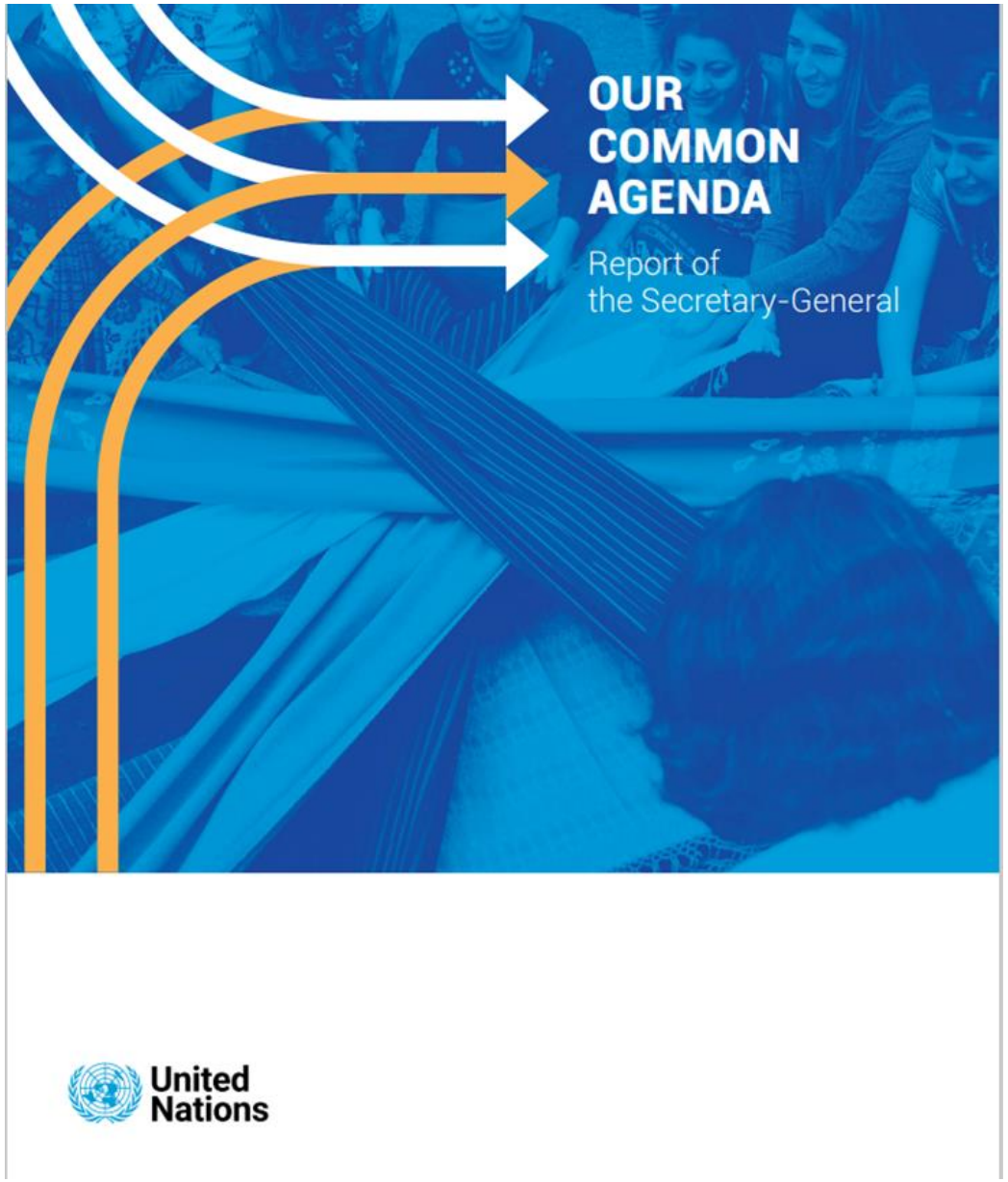
The G7 / BRICS

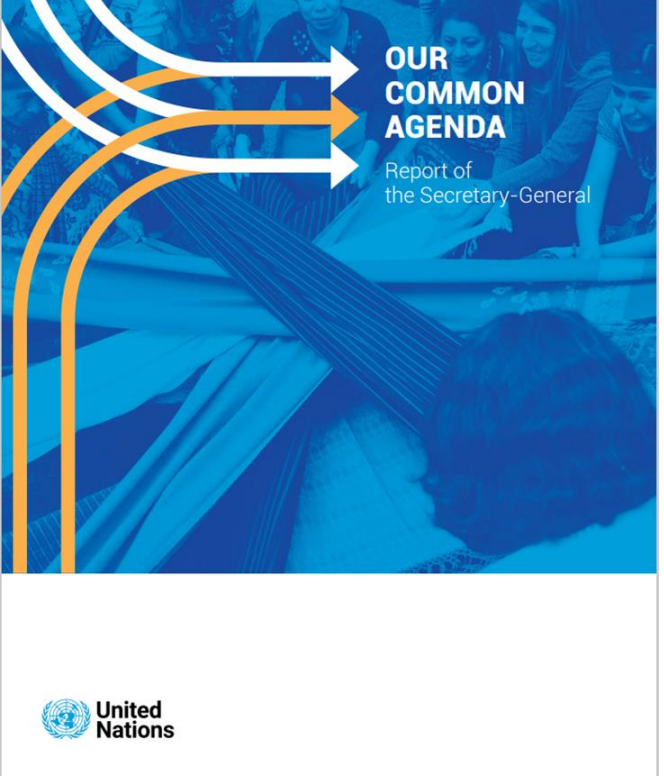
The Shanghai Cooperation Organization

NATO

*List not exhaustive

In comes…


OUR
COMMON
AGENDA
Report of
the Secretary-General
United
Nations

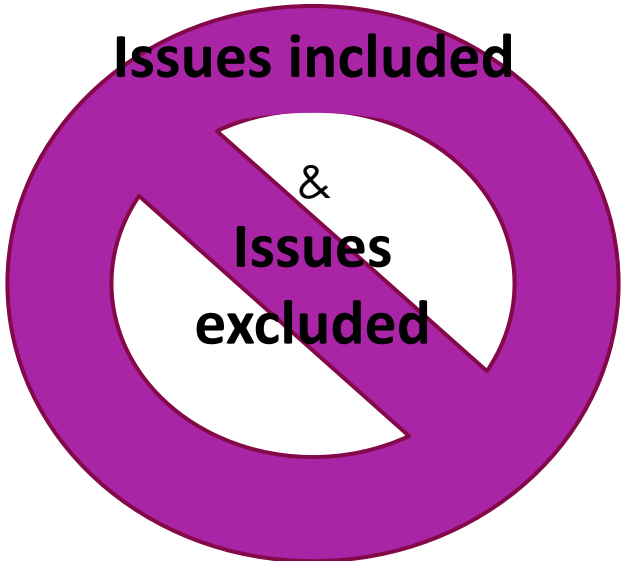



Emphasis on women and youth*
(and future generations)

New social contract needed
nationally and globally

Multi-stakeholderism confirmed as the
new multilateralism?

Ad hoc bodies rather than standing
ones (see Emergency Platform)?



# What do we do as active global citizens? Some suggestions…

Critical support for OCA proposals –
no blanket endorsement

Formulation of Civil Society « Golden Package »,
if we can agree on one

Consult with and mobilize people
and our constituencies at all levels

Work with the Secretary-General, the General Assembly President,
Member States and Groups of States,
in a problem-solving, transparent and constructive spirit

***TWO YEARS WITH A LOT TO DO AHEAD OF US!***

# *Thank You!*

**For your attention and your actions!**

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